

Day 3 — The Moon’s House Visits

Module: Moon Phases & Tithi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children meet the idea that the Moon visits a different “house” (star pattern) every night — a folktale-style framing of the 27 *nakṣatras*. The Sanskrit word *nakṣatra* is introduced softly without drilling.

Materials

- A printed Moon and 27 paper “house” stars arranged in a circle on the floor (or on a wall poster)
- Drawing paper

The flow

Settle + recall (3 min)

Chant: “*am - mah - vāh - yah! poor - ni - mah!*” — three times.

Recall: “*Is the Moon growing or shrinking right now?*” (Refer to the day’s actual sky if children have observed.)

Story (12 min)

The Moon Visits Its House Family

Long, long ago, the Moon — whose name is *Soma* — had 27 sisters. Each sister lived in her own house, high up in the sky. Together they were the family of *nakṣatras* — the “star houses.”

Every night, the Moon visited ONE of his 27 sister houses. He never visited two on the same night. So one night he was in the house called *Aśvinī*. The next night, *Bharaṇī*. The next, *Kṛttikā*. And so on, all 27 sisters, one per night.

After 27 nights, he had visited every sister. Then he started over — back to *Aśvinī*.

(Children love this. Walk a paper Moon around the 27 stars on the floor, naming a few of them as you go.)

Now — the Moon also changes shape every night, as we learned. Sometimes he is full (*pūrṇimā*), sometimes he disappears (*amāvasyā*). Some old stories say his sisters are happy when he is full, and worried when he disappears.

But every month, he comes back to the same sister he visited a month ago. So if tonight the Moon is in the house of *Citrā*, in about a month, the Moon will visit *Citrā* again.

That’s why our months in India are named after the sisters. The month *Caitra* is named after *Citrā*. The month *Kārtika* is named after *Kṛttikā*. The Moon’s sisters give the months their names.

Activity (10 min)

Each child: 1. Draws the Moon in the middle of a paper. 2. Draws 4 little “house stars” around the Moon (we’ll do 4, not 27). 3. Labels one of the houses with the name *Aśvinī* (or any nakṣatra name the teacher chooses). 4. Draws arrows showing the Moon’s path from one house to the next.

This is a drawing exercise. Don’t drill the names.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Show a few drawings.
- “*What did we learn? The Moon visits a new house every night. There are 27 houses in all. The Moon’s sisters give our months their names.*”
- **Homework:** Look at the Moon tonight. What shape? Write the date.

Homework

- Continue the Moon Diary.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Try drawing all 27 houses in a ring around the Moon.
- **Tier down:** Just draw the Moon and one house. The story is the lesson — the drawing supports it.

Teacher’s quick notes

- The “27 sisters” framing is a teaching tool drawing on traditional stories (the Dakṣa’s daughters narrative appears in several *Purāṇas*, with the Moon as *Soma* / *Candra*). At Primary band, frame it as “an old story” — don’t claim a single canonical source.
- The point: children learn that the Moon’s position in the sky changes night by night, in a 27-night cycle (the *sidereal* month — different from the 30-day *synodic* month, but we don’t need that distinction yet).
- If a child asks “why don’t the houses come back to the same place every 30 nights?” — that’s a great question, and you can tell them they’ll learn about it in Middle school. (The answer: because Earth has moved around the Sun during the 27 days too.)
- Some children may know specific nakṣatras from their birth chart. That’s fine — let them share, but don’t dwell on astrology.